What did, however, happen after demonetization was that a massive amount of data on people and companies who were purportedly avoiding tax, became available to the tax authorities.

Finance Minister Jaitley stated in May 2017 that the Income Tax Department had identified 1.8 million persons whose cash deposits during the demonetization period were not in line with their tax profile, and had sent them tax notices asking for explanations. Transactions of over 3,00,000 registered companies were investigated and 'more than 37,000 shell companies which were engaged in hiding black money and hawala transactions' were identified.

The assets seized and undisclosed income detected as a consequence of these actions by the Income Tax department was shared in response to a question in the Rajya Sabha, in December 2017, and are summarized in the following table:

Table 13: Assets Seized and Income Detected Post-Demonetization

Dates	IT Searches and Surveys	Assets Seized (₹ Cr)	Income Detected (₹ Cr)
November 2016–March 2017	9,139	900	14,706
April 2017–October 2017	3,463	573	10,285
Total	12,602	1,473	24,991

Source: Minister of State for Finance, P. Radhakrishnan in a written reply to the Rajya Sabha, on 19 December 2017.

This implies that of the 1.8 million individuals and 3,00,000 companies identified, surveys and searches were carried out on only 12,000, leading to an income disclosure of an average of ₹2 crore per entity – a paltry amount by any stretch of imagination. It is hard to understand why the authorities have been so slow to mine the data they have collected and not taken tangible steps to bring more evaders into the tax net.